ALLY WEALTH • AUTHOR VISIBILITY CONSULTANT

Social Media Book Promotion Guide

Build a sustainable, reader-focused presence across social channels.

A practical workbook and reference guide

EDUCATIONAL RESOURCE • 2026 EDITION

How to use this guide

Social media can help readers encounter an author, discover a book and join a conversation. It is not a substitute for a clear book page or a promise of sales. Platforms differ in audience, formats, culture and rules; choose channels based on reader fit and your ability to create consistently.

Work through the pages in order. Use the prompts to make decisions, record assumptions and identify actions. You can revisit a page when your book, audience or publishing plan changes.

Keep the work evidence-aware. Platform interfaces, policies and marketplace features change. Verify current official guidance before acting on platform-specific instructions. Treat examples as planning aids, not guarantees.

Make it your own. Not every tactic belongs in every campaign. Choose the actions that fit your book, resources, readers and values.

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01 / FIELD GUIDE

Choose a clear social objective

Decide whether the next period is about awareness, community, email sign-ups, event attendance or book-page visits. One primary objective makes content decisions easier.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **choose a clear social objective**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

02 / FIELD GUIDE

Find the reader-channel fit

Study where your likely readers already spend time and what formats they enjoy. Do not choose a channel only because it is popular with other authors.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **find the reader-channel fit**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Set a sustainable platform mix

Select one primary channel and, if useful, one secondary channel. Repurpose ideas thoughtfully while adapting tone, length and format to each platform.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **set a sustainable platform mix**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Build content pillars

Choose three to five recurring themes linked to your book and author identity. A balanced mix may include book context, craft, research, reader questions and personal perspective within your boundaries.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **build content pillars**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Create a simple content calendar

Plan a manageable cadence around writing time, launch milestones and real-life commitments. Include room for spontaneous conversations and breaks.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **create a simple content calendar**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Write strong post openings

Give readers a clear reason to pause: a question, useful insight, surprising detail or relatable situation. Avoid misleading hooks that the post does not fulfil.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **write strong post openings**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Tell stories without oversharing

Share the creative process, research or decisions behind a book while protecting private information and other people’s stories. The reader should gain context, not access to everything.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **tell stories without oversharing**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Make short-form video useful

Use a clear opening, one central idea, readable captions and a purposeful ending. Video does not need elaborate effects; clarity and sound quality matter.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **make short-form video useful**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Plan book-focused video ideas

Consider premise explanations, character or topic introductions, research notes, reading-order guidance and answers to reader questions. Avoid spoilers unless clearly signposted.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **plan book-focused video ideas**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Use images with intention

Choose images that reinforce the message and remain legible on mobile. Use licensed or original visuals and add alternative text where supported.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **use images with intention**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Write captions for scanning

Put the central idea early, break up dense text and use a small number of relevant hashtags if they genuinely help categorisation. Avoid keyword piles.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **write captions for scanning**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Invite meaningful conversation

Ask questions readers can answer comfortably. Respond with curiosity and respect; do not manufacture arguments or demand engagement.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **invite meaningful conversation**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

- Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?
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Working notes

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Respect platform communities

Follow community norms, disclosure rules and promotional limits. Do not flood comments, mass-message strangers or use automated engagement schemes.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **respect platform communities**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Use calls to action sparingly

Choose one next step: read an article, visit the book page, join an opt-in list or attend an event. Make the destination clear and relevant.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **use calls to action sparingly**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Build an email bridge

Social platforms are rented channels and reach can change. If appropriate, invite interested readers to an opt-in newsletter with a clear value proposition and consent.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **build an email bridge**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Coordinate launch content

Plan pre-launch context, release information, launch-week reminders and post-launch follow-up. Do not repeat the same sales message in every post.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **coordinate launch content**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Create a reusable asset bank

Store approved cover images, short descriptions, author photos, video clips and captions. Track rights, source files and version dates.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **create a reusable asset bank**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Collaborate with creators ethically

Research audience fit and content style. Agree scope, fees, deadlines, disclosure and usage rights in writing. Do not require positive opinions or guaranteed coverage.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **collaborate with creators ethically**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Understand paid promotion basics

Set an objective, audience hypothesis, budget and test period before spending. Check current platform advertising rules and track the destination page.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **understand paid promotion basics**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

- Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?
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Working notes

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Read performance metrics

Understand reach, impressions, watch time, saves, shares, clicks and conversions. Each measures a different behaviour; do not treat high views as proof of book sales.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **read performance metrics**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Run small experiments

Change one major variable at a time where possible: opening, creative, audience or call to action. Keep a record and avoid drawing conclusions from tiny samples.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **run small experiments**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Handle negative comments

Set moderation rules, block harassment and respond to genuine questions calmly. You are not obliged to debate bad-faith comments or expose private details.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **handle negative comments**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Protect your account

Use strong unique passwords, multifactor authentication where available and careful access management. Be cautious of fake sponsorship messages and suspicious links.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **protect your account**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Avoid misleading tactics

Do not buy followers, fake engagement, impersonate readers or misrepresent endorsements. These tactics undermine trust and may violate platform terms.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **avoid misleading tactics**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Create a weekly workflow

Batch idea capture, drafting, asset creation, scheduling and replies into manageable blocks. Leave space for writing and client or business work.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **create a weekly workflow**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Repurpose content intelligently

Turn a substantial idea into a short video, a text post, an email note or a website article. Reframe the message for the channel rather than duplicating blindly.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **repurpose content intelligently**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Build a post-launch rhythm

Continue useful conversations after launch through reader questions, themes, events and evergreen content. Avoid treating a book as relevant only on release day.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **build a post-launch rhythm**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Review channel performance monthly

Compare results with the objective, note what attracted the right audience and adjust cadence. Pause channels that create disproportionate work without useful signals.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **review channel performance monthly**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Create a crisis and correction plan

If you publish an error, correct it clearly. If a platform is unavailable, use your website or opt-in email channel for essential updates.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **create a crisis and correction plan**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Your 30-day social plan

Set one objective, choose channels, map content pillars, schedule a realistic cadence and define the metrics you will review.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **your 30-day social plan**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

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Working notes